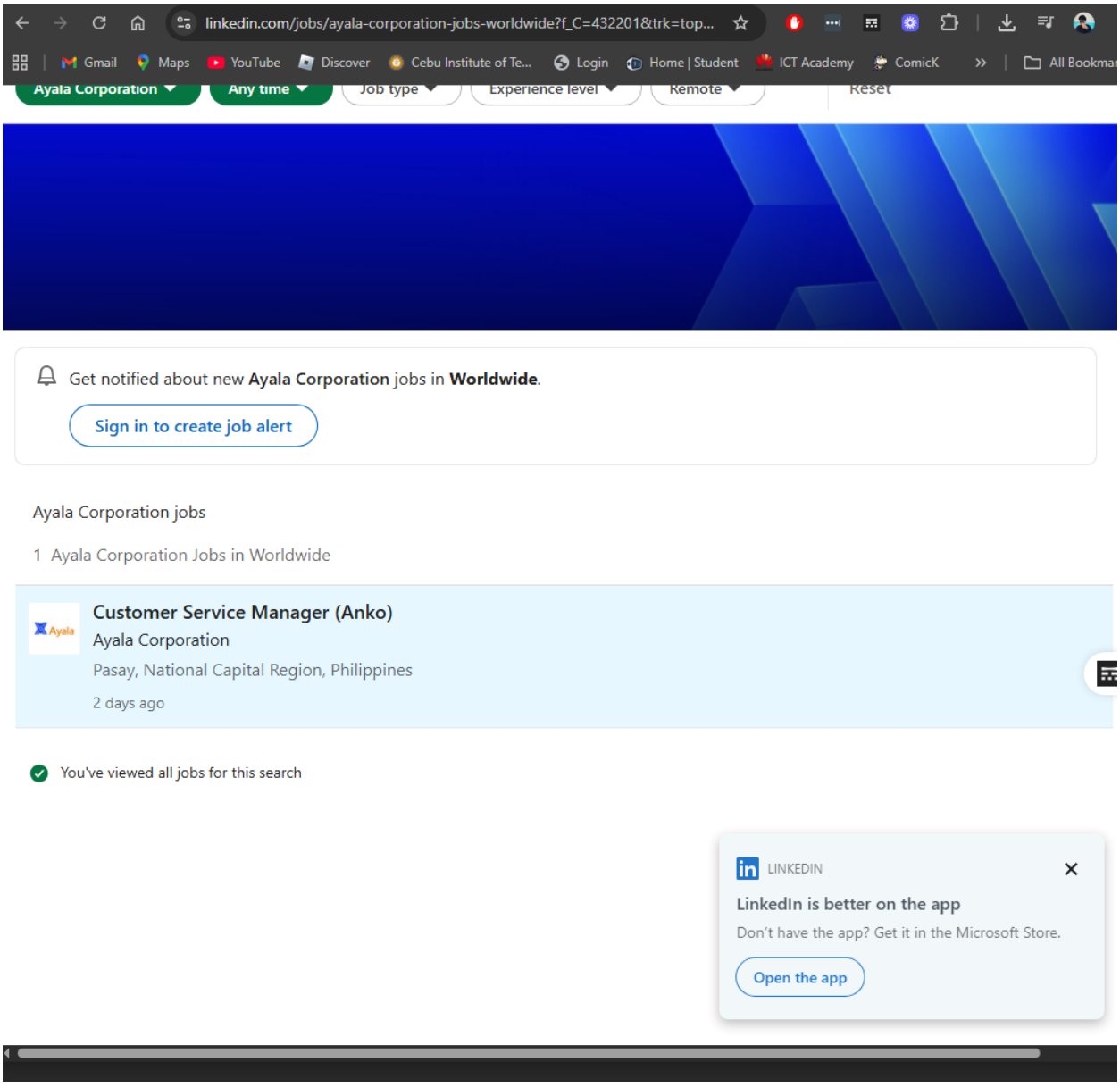
Phishing Lure via OSINT

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Section: *G6*
Date: *September 12, 2025*

Section A: OSINT Findings – Ayala Corporation

1. **Job Role Found:** Ayala Corporation is actively hiring for **Customer Service Manager (Anko)**, based in Pasay, NCR.



2. **Employee Name:** Job is posted by **Crisia Llante, CLDP**, who works in **Talent Management** at Ayala Corporation.
3. **Location:** The role is based in **Pasay, NCR**, which could be referenced for regional relevance.
4. **Platform:** Job posted on **LinkedIn**, which implies candidates/applicants may monitor email regularly during the hiring process.
5. **Job Tasks Mentioned:** Includes terms like **data reporting tools**, **compliance**, **team engagement**, **safety training**, and **coaching**—useful keywords for social engineering.

Section B: Phishing Email (Simulation)

Subject Line: Urgent: Update Required – Anko Candidate Onboarding Portal Security Patch

From: Ayala IT Services <support@ayala-itupdates.com.ph>

To: crisia.llante@ayala.com.ph

Hi Crisia,

As part of our enhanced security compliance procedures for Ayala's **Talent Management** division, especially concerning new Anko hiring pipelines, our internal audit team has flagged an outdated module in the **Candidate Onboarding Portal** affecting several job posts—including the recent **Customer Service Manager (Anko)** listing.

We are issuing an immediate patch to prevent data leaks and ensure safe data processing during high-volume recruitment periods.

Please verify your credentials and update the portal configuration by accessing the secure HR panel below:

Click here to update your onboarding module!

This action is required by **Friday, September 13th** to avoid restricted access to applicant submissions and reporting tools.

If you have any issues, contact internal IT security immediately.

Warm regards,

—

Ayala IT Security Team
Internal Services – Ayala Corporation
support@ayala.com.ph | internal.ayala.com.ph

Section C: Analysis

Why the crafted email would be convincing to the target:

- The email targets a specific role (**Talent Management / HR**) with references to real, publicly available information, such as the **Customer Service Manager (Anko)** job opening.
- It uses official-sounding language and mimics internal IT communication, increasing perceived legitimacy.
- The sender's email address looks professional and closely resembles a legitimate internal Ayala domain.
- The email references specific internal systems like the **Candidate Onboarding Portal** and mentions an urgent **security patch**, which aligns with typical IT security communications.
- The deadline to update the system creates pressure to act quickly, reducing the likelihood of thorough scrutiny.

Psychological triggers used:

- **Urgency:** The deadline ("required by Friday, September 13th") pushes the recipient to act quickly.
- **Authority:** The email claims to be from the "Ayala IT Security Team," a trusted internal source.
- **Fear:** The risk of "restricted access to applicant submissions and reporting tools" creates concern over potential consequences.
- **Curiosity:** Refers to a "security patch" and "outdated module," which might prompt the recipient to investigate by clicking the link.

Section D: Reflection

1. Why is spear-phishing more effective than generic spam?
Spear-phishing is targeted and personalized using specific details about the recipient or organization, making it appear legitimate and relevant. This reduces suspicion and increases the chance the victim will engage with the email.

2. Which OSINT data points made your phishing email convincing?

- The **Customer Service Manager (Anko)** job title from the LinkedIn post.

- Reference to the **Talent Management** team and onboarding process.
- Use of internal system terms like **Candidate Onboarding Portal** and **reporting tools**.
- The timing and urgency consistent with typical IT security communications.

3. How could the target organization defend against this type of attack?

- Implement **email authentication protocols** like SPF, DKIM, and DMARC to prevent spoofing.
- Use **email filtering and anti-phishing software** that flags suspicious links or domains.
- Require **multi-factor authentication (MFA)** for accessing internal portals.
- Conduct regular **security awareness training** focused on recognizing phishing.
- Establish clear **internal communication policies** specifying official communication channels.

4. What security awareness training would you recommend for the employees you targeted?

- Training on how to **verify sender email addresses and domain authenticity**.
- Awareness of **phishing tactics** including urgency and authority manipulation.
- Guidance on **safe handling of links and attachments**, including hovering over links before clicking.
- Clear procedures for **reporting suspicious emails** immediately to IT/security teams.
- Regular simulated phishing exercises to **test and reinforce** employee vigilance.